

Blind Spot Autobiography Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and the Knower • 20 min

Category	Knowledge and the Knower	Time	20 min
Difficulty	Easy	ID	blind-spot-autobiography

Big idea: Self-knowledge includes awareness of limits.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students reflect on the limits of their own knowing without forced disclosure.

Student Prompt

Inspect Blind Spot Autobiography Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Blind Spot Autobiography Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: A private reflection on one belief students changed without sharing sensitive content. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Blind Spot Autobiography Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: A 'known unknowns' box for topics students realise they rarely question. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Blind Spot Autobiography Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A perspective inventory naming communities that make some assumptions feel obvious. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Self-knowledge includes awareness of limits.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Blind Spot Autobiography Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Blind Spot Autobiography Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	Can knowing your bias make you less biased?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Knowledge and the Knower.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how self-knowledge includes awareness of limits.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: Can knowing your bias make you less biased?

Setup Checklist

- Prepare a starter stimulus using: A private reflection on one belief students changed without sharing sensitive content.
- Print or project the student response grid before the activity begins.
- Plan a private first-response moment before any group discussion.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- A private reflection on one belief students changed without sharing sensitive content.
- A 'known unknowns' box for topics students realise they rarely question.
- A perspective inventory naming communities that make some assumptions feel obvious.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/blind-spot-autobiography/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/blind-spot-autobiography/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/blind-spot-autobiography/visual-prompt.svg>
- Printable student worksheet with observation, inference, evidence, and confidence columns.
- Teacher notes with setup checklist, sample facilitation language, misconceptions, and assessment look-fors.
- Classroom run kit with prompt cards, example stimuli, and debrief moves.
- PowerPoint deck with a student-facing sequence for running the activity.

Run Sequence

1. Students privately complete three prompts: "Something I used to believe", "Something I strongly believe but cannot fully prove", and "Something I may be biased about".
2. Students choose one safe example to discuss with a partner, or keep all examples private.
3. The class builds a list of causes of blind spots: identity, language, friendship group, schooling, emotion, incentives and media.
4. Finish with a one-sentence reflection: "A good knower should..."

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: Can knowing your bias make you less biased?
- Is self-knowledge necessary for reliable knowledge?
- When does perspective become distortion?

Teacher Quick Script

- Write your first judgement before we discuss it; the first answer is useful evidence.
- Separate what you noticed from what you inferred.
- What would make this knowledge claim more reliable?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...